

the Windows Phone 7 operating system after it failed to convince developers or consumers to back its home-grown Symbian or MeeGo platform. Most Nokia loyalists have since switched to rival platforms, mostly to Android and iPhone platforms.

He later told journalists that Google had 'confidential negotiations' with Nokia that were 'very extensive'.

Had Google succeeded in convincing Nokia to adopt Android, together they would have commanded more than half of the mobile OS market. This would have given undue advantage to the alliance. With Microsoft, Nokia is still in the running in what Stephen Elop referred to as a 'three horse race'.

Android to make more sense for enterprises

RIM's Blackberry platform has traditionally been a favourite when it comes to mobile enterprise security and its management. Its Blackberry Enterprise Server offers encryption that is virtually impregnable—a fact repeatedly confirmed by Indian security agencies.

However, in recent times, the stronghold of Blackberry as the preferred business tool has been diminishing constantly. First, because Apple has turned iOS devices into potent personal as well as business communication tools, through a series of updates. Second, if Blackberry users have to access their personal data on their handset, they have to log out of the corporate resource network (VPN, internal Wi-Fi, etc) and log in again separately to access personal data. To correct this, RIM recently announced the Blackberry Balance software, which will separate the two types of resources from one another—featuring the famous security for enterprise resources and at the same time keeping the publicly available apps and data separate. It will take a few months before this is made available. Meanwhile, this feature announcement could make potential defectors to the iPhone have a second look at their Blackberries.

The growing influence of Android among smartphones and tablets has also contributed to the decreasing popularity of Blackberry among corporate users. However, owing to its open source nature, Android has repeatedly been accused of being unstable, fragmented and unsuitable for enterprise use. Some of the more deadly Trojans that have been made on the Android platform could steal your credit card number just by listening to your voice! Some would argue against even considering such a platform for businesses. The truth is that Android has rapidly grown in influence and market share. It would be hard to ignore such a big platform, even with regard to enterprise usage.

While Google itself is busy doling out new updates for Android twice every year, two OEMs—Samsung and Motorola—have taken it upon themselves to make Android more secure for enterprise usage. Both the companies have seen their fortunes rise after they agreed to get Android onto their smartphones. It is profitable for them to make it more appealing to a much bigger customer base. RIM seems to have more or less given up on the 'App Store' race as it is mulling over getting Android apps to run on the RIM environment.

Samsung announced at the Mobile World Congress that it would use hardware-based encryption to make its phones more secure. By using in-device encryption, not only is it getting the hardware to do more, but would also prevent the OS from getting involved and suffering from performance

HTC joins tablet war with 'HTC Flyer'

HTC has finally entered the tablet wars with the announcement of the HTC Flyer—a 17.8 cm (7-inch) Android 2.4 powered device. The tablet will run a 1.5 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon processor along with 1GB of RAM. It will also feature the HTC Scribe, which is a new pressure-sensitive capacitive touch technology optimised for a stylus. In other words, it is a new digital ink technology designed to give the user an experience of using a pen to take notes or draw pictures on the tablet. The device will also come with built-in synchronisation to the popular note-taking app, Evernote.

It will also feature 32 GB of memory, which can be expanded through a microSD slot. The Flyer will come loaded with a 5-megapixel camera, a 1.3-megapixel front facing camera, and a 4000mAh battery, which will be able to play up-to 5 hours of continuous video.

Make your own Android robot

You might recall the friendly little green robot that is the mascot for Android products. Google has launched an application that lets you customise the robot with your own elements, external features, accessories, etc.

You could then share it across social-media platforms, make it into your wallpaper or your online avatar or do anything else with it. Though it's not exactly a 'productive' activity, it's still a fun way to unwind for a while. You could download it at Androidify.com.

